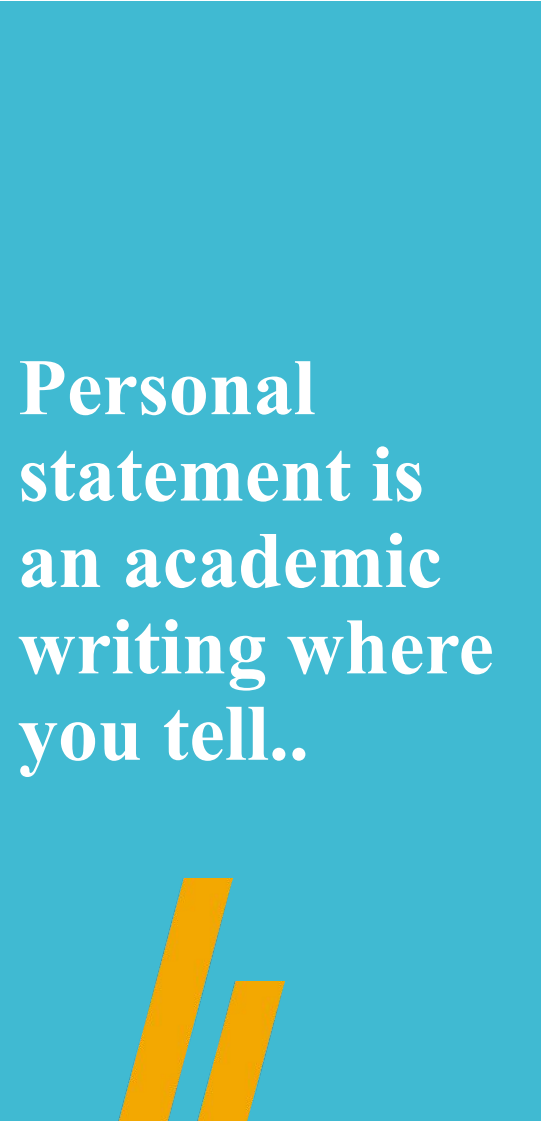


**Personal
Statement Writing**

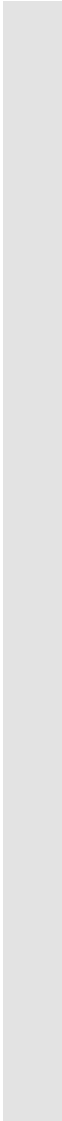
Expository Writing

Week 10



**Personal
statement is
an academic
writing where
you tell..**

Your life story through the
lens of what you want to do
after you graduate.



Importance....

- An opportunity for the reviewer to gain a fuller understanding of the applicant(in lieu of an interview)
- The basis for assessing how the applicant might contribute to the selected discipline, the student body, or the profession
- an indicator of applicant's writing ability and judgement
- An indicator of applicant's interest level in the degree which he wishes to pursue
- PS is your opportunity to sell yourself in the application process.
- It normally describes one special, unique, distinct, and/or impressive story about YOU.

Overall, You Want to..

- Show you are emotionally/personally invested
- Show a proven track record of achievement
- Indicate goals/a vision for the future

Why do you need to write a personal statement?

- Often a graduate school, college or a university require a personal statement from their applicants along with the application.
- At times for a specific scholarship.
- What personal characteristics (i.e. resilience, integrity, compassion, and/or persistence) do you possess that would improve your prospects for success in college?

Why offer YOU a place?

Lots of students apply with the predicted grades, so why offer YOU a place?

1. Because you have the required grades
2. Because of the positive comments in the your reference
3. Because of your personal statement

What Does a Personal Statement include?

Details of your life that might help the committee better understand you or help set you apart from other applicants.

Mention the abilities and traits that will serve you well as a student/aspiring professional

Write about the experience that relate to the course

Conferences, residential courses, trips, people you have met, something you have read, hobbies, future plans or anything relevant that will convince the admissions tutors that you have given a serious thoughts to the choice of the course.

List any prizes you
have won – either
inside or outside
school

What would you say
has been your
biggest achievement
and why?

Has anyone
motivated you?
If so, who and why?

Do you have a
favourite book,
film, hobby?
How have they
influenced you?

Have you faced any
difficulties in life?
Did it change you?

Have you worked
hard for something
and finally achieved
your goal?

Where do you see
yourself in 5 years
time?

What would your
friends/family say
if they were writing
your statement?

Basic Structure

- Introduce yourself , state your purpose and reason it out through three supporting points (how you would achieve your purpose)
- Academic details and accomplishments
- personal experience leading to develop certain skills
- Future aspirations and goals
- Reiterate your core message, express your enthusiasm, leave a memorable final thought

Basically you have to persuade them that YOU are the right candidate and should DESERVE a spot/place

Key Takeaways

- Get a short list of your most powerful stories about yourself.
- Plan what you need to prove about yourself to others.
- Mark that plan out with topic sentences and transitions.
- Use your stories to ground your statements in examples.

Plan the purpose and placement of each paragraph

- Start each paragraph with a topic sentence that speaks to the prompt
- Ground the claim in your topic sentence with a powerful example from your life
- Explain what that experience meant to you

One Quick Example with Topic Sentences

- I became interested in education when...
- My own learning experiences helped me realize...
- Volunteering gave me new ways to help others...
- I have chosen to pursue X because of Y...

OUTLINE STRUCTURE

■ Introduction

- Write a hook, a compelling anecdote, a rhetorical question, or a striking fact that highlights your personality, values, and goals, while engaging the reader's senses.
- Briefly introduce yourself and your aspirations, connecting them to the captivating opening.
- Form a thesis statement having a clear purpose followed by three points (based on your three abilities/skills developed through academic achievement, personal experience, and future goals).
- Transitional hook

■ Body paragraph: Academic achievements

- Provide a topic sentence introducing the academic details and accomplishments leading to skill development that would help you achieve your purpose.

■ Body paragraph: Personal experiences

- Provide a topic sentence introducing the personal experiences leading to skill development that would help you achieve your purpose.

■ Body paragraph: Future goals

- Provide a topic sentence introducing the future goals and their impact on society.

■ Conclusion

- Reiterate your core message, express your enthusiasm, leave a memorable final thought

Personal Statement Prompt

Admissions Open: BS Computer Science
Are you fascinated by technology and the endless possibilities of innovation? Do you aspire to become a part of the rapidly evolving world of computing, software development, artificial intelligence, game development, and digital problem-solving? Our BS Computer Science program invites passionate, creative, and motivated students who are eager to shape the future through technology.

- **Write a personal statement** explaining why you want to join the BS Computer Science program, what inspired your interest in this field, what qualities or experiences make you a suitable candidate, and how you hope to contribute to the world of technology in the future.

Example

Introductory Paragraph

Every time you reach into your pocket and pull out your phone, you are holding more computing power than the systems that once guided humanity to the moon. What was once a triumph of enormous machines, brilliant minds, and extraordinary effort is now something you carry with you every single day.*(hook)*. As a 17-year-old aspiring computer scientist, I, Muhammad Ahmed, am driven by the rapid advancements in technology to contribute to this dynamic field. Steve Job's assertion that technology will revolutionize education inspires my pursuit of a computer science degree. *(lead-in)*. I aim to contribute to the advancement of technology through Computer Science by **innovating** within the space in gaming industries, **problem-solving** complex challenges in these fields and **contributing** to the growth of e-sports *(Thesis)*. That power drives my interest in both *game development and evolution*. *(transitional hook with two controlling ideas)*